
Using AI Tools to Prepare Official Statistical Reports

A Practical Learning Guide for NSO Nepal Staff

About this guide

This guide is designed for NSO Nepal staff who are comfortable with data tools (Excel, SPSS, Stata) but are new to AI writing assistants. It is practical and hands-on — every step includes real prompts and examples drawn from NSO Nepal's own publications.

AI Tools Covered:

ChatGPT · Claude · Gemini · DeepSeek · Qwen · and other free tools

Language: English

Prepared for: National Statistics Office of Nepal (NSO Nepal)

Date: June 2026

Contents

1	Step 1 of 8 — What AI Is (and Isn't): The Right Mental Model	3
2	Step 2 of 8 — Prompt Engineering: How to Talk to AI Effectively	5
3	Step 3 of 8 — Structuring and Outlining Official Statistical Reports	8
4	Step 4 of 8 — Drafting Narratives: Turning Tables and Charts into Official Text	10
5	Step 5 of 8 — Drafting Executive Summaries and Press Releases	12
6	Step 6 of 8 — Editing, Rewriting, and Tone Adjustment	13
7	Step 7 of 8 — Fact-Checking and Verification: Never Trust AI Blindly	15
8	Step 8 of 8 — Ethics, Privacy, and Responsible AI Use	17
	Quick Reference Card	18

1 Step 1 of 8 — What AI Is (and Isn't): The Right Mental Model

TL;DR

AI writing tools like ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, DeepSeek, and Qwen are **powerful text assistants** — they help you draft, rewrite, summarize, and structure documents faster. But they are **not databases of facts**: they can generate plausible-sounding but incorrect statistics, so you must always verify numbers against your official NSO sources.

How It Works

Think of these AI tools like a **very well-read, fast-writing colleague** who:

1. Has read millions of documents — reports, textbooks, news articles, government publications
2. Can write fluently in formal, professional English on almost any topic
3. **But** has no access to your computer, your databases, or real-time data
4. **And** sometimes “fills in” facts it doesn’t know with plausible-sounding guesses (*this is called a **hallucination***)

The five tools you’ll use — at a glance:

Tool	Access	Best For	Free?
ChatGPT (OpenAI)	chat.openai.com	Drafting, summarizing, rewrites	✓ Free tier
Claude (Anthropic)	claude.ai	Long documents, precise editing	✓ Free tier
Gemini (Google)	gemini.google.com	Summarizing, Google Docs integration	✓ Free
DeepSeek	chat.deepseek.com	Drafting, analysis, reasoning	✓ Fully free
Qwen (Alibaba)	qwen.ai	Long-form writing, multilingual	✓ Fully free

Deep Dive

What AI is excellent for (✓)

- Drafting narrative paragraphs from **data you provide**
- Rewriting awkward sentences into formal English
- Generating report outlines and structures
- Translating between formal and plain language
- Suggesting headings and section titles

What AI is unreliable for (✗)

- Quoting specific statistics (e.g., Nepal's poverty rate in 2023)
- Citing laws, policies, or official definitions (unless you paste the text in)
- Any number, date, or source you haven't explicitly given it

A real NSO Nepal example

✗ Risky — never do this:

"What was Nepal's GDP growth rate in FY 2023/24?"

AI may answer confidently with a wrong number.

✓ Safe — always do this:

"Here is Nepal's GDP growth data from our National Accounts 2023/24:

Real GDP growth: 3.9%

Agriculture sector growth: 2.8%

Industry sector growth: 3.2%

Services sector growth: 4.6%

Please write a formal paragraph summarizing this trend for a press release."

You bring the data. AI brings the words.

Key takeaway: AI tools are writing accelerators, not fact sources. Your expertise in statistics is irreplaceable — AI just helps you express it faster and more clearly.

2 Step 2 of 8 — Prompt Engineering: How to Talk to AI Effectively

TL;DR

A **prompt** is the instruction you type into an AI tool. The quality of AI output depends almost entirely on the quality of your prompt — a vague prompt gives vague output, while a structured, specific prompt gives professional, usable output.

Methodology

The **RCTF Framework** for NSO report writing prompts:

Element	What to include	Example
Role	Tell AI who it is	"You are an official report writer for NSO Nepal"
Context	Provide your data/situation	"Here is our CPI data for Q2 2024..."
Task	State exactly what you want	"Write a 3-paragraph press release narrative"
Format	Specify format, length, tone	"Formal, 150 words, no bullet points"

How It Works

Think of prompting like giving instructions to a new, very capable staff member:

- The more precise your instruction, the better the output
- You can always refine and ask again — this is called **iteration**
- You are always in control — AI does not decide anything on its own

Step-by-step prompting process:

1. **Open** your chosen AI tool (DeepSeek, ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or Qwen)
2. **Set the role** — tell AI what kind of expert it should be
3. **Paste your data** — paste the actual numbers from your spreadsheet or report
4. **State the task** clearly — what document, section, or text do you need?
5. **Specify format** — length, tone, structure, language level
6. **Review and iterate** — ask AI to revise if the first output isn't right

Deep Dive

Prompt templates for NSO Nepal

Template 1: Basic narrative paragraph

You are an official statistical report writer for the National Statistics Office of Nepal (NSO Nepal).

Here is data from our [report name]:
[Paste your data here]

Write a formal narrative paragraph (100-150 words) for our [publication name] that:

- Summarizes the key trends in the data
- Uses formal, neutral, official language
- Does not add any statistics not present in the data I provided
- Is suitable for a government statistical publication

Template 2: Structured with specific instructions

You are a senior economist drafting text for NSO Nepal's Consumer Price Index (CPI) bulletin.

Data (FY 2023/24, Nepal):

- Overall CPI: 5.4% (year-on-year)
- Food and beverages: 6.1%
- Non-food and services: 4.9%
- Urban CPI: 5.6%
- Rural CPI: 5.2%

Task: Write the opening paragraph for the monthly CPI press release. It should:

1. State the headline CPI figure
2. Compare food vs. non-food inflation
3. Note the urban-rural difference
4. Use formal, official tone appropriate for a government press release
5. Be no longer than 120 words
6. Do not fabricate any additional statistics

Template 3: Refining/iterating on output

Thank you. Please revise the paragraph to:

- Use more formal/academic language
- Replace the word "significant" with a more precise phrase
- Make it shorter (under 100 words)
- Start with the headline figure, not the context

Common prompting mistakes

✗ Weak Prompt	✓ Strong Prompt
"Write about Nepal's economy"	"Write a formal 150-word paragraph on Nepal's GDP growth for FY 2023/24 using this data: [data]"
"Make this better"	"Rewrite this paragraph in a more formal tone, suitable for an official NSO publication"
"Summarize the report"	"Summarize the key findings of the attached poverty data into 5 bullet points for a press release"
"Write a press release"	"Write a 300-word press release announcing Nepal's 2024 poverty headcount results. Use formal English. Data: [data]"

Key takeaway: Master the RCTF framework (Role, Context, Task, Format) and you will get professional, usable output from any AI tool every time.

3 Step 3 of 8 — Structuring and Outlining Official Statistical Reports

TL;DR

Before writing a single sentence, use AI to generate a complete, logical report outline — tailored to the type of statistical publication you are producing. This saves hours of planning and ensures no key section is missed.

Methodology

Standard NSO Nepal publication types and their typical structures:

Publication Type	Key Sections
CPI Bulletin	Highlights → Methodology Note → Trend Analysis → Group-wise Analysis → Tables
Economic Survey Chapter	Overview → Sectoral Analysis → Indicators → Policy Implications → Statistical Annex
Press Release	Headline Finding → Key Statistics → Trend Context → Methodology Note → Contact
Census Report Chapter	Introduction → Geographic Distribution → Demographic Analysis → Comparison → Conclusions
Annual Statistical Abstract	Foreword → Contents → Thematic Chapters → Technical Notes → Glossary

How It Works

1. Identify your publication type (CPI bulletin, census chapter, press release, etc.)
2. Ask AI to generate an outline with section headings and sub-headings
3. Review the outline against NSO Nepal’s house style and past publications
4. Adjust any sections to match your specific data and requirements
5. Use the approved outline as your writing roadmap

Deep Dive

Prompt: Generate a report outline

You are an official report writer at the National Statistics Office of Nepal.

I am preparing the [Quarterly Consumer Price Index Bulletin / Annual Poverty Report / Population Census Chapter -- choose one].

The report will cover: [describe your report, e.g., "CPI data for Q2 FY 2023/24 for Nepal, with national, urban and rural breakdowns, and commodity group analysis"].

Please generate a complete section-by-section outline for this report. For each section, provide:

1. The section heading
2. 2-3 sub-headings or bullet points describing what that section should contain
3. Suggested approximate word count for each section

The outline should follow the structure of a formal government statistical publication.

Example output — CPI Bulletin Outline

Consumer Price Index Bulletin — Q2 FY 2023/24

1. Highlights (150 words)

- Key headline figure
- Notable movements in major groups
- Comparison with previous quarter

2. Methodology Note (100 words)

- Base year and reference period
- Data collection approach
- Commodity basket coverage

3. National CPI Trend Analysis (300 words)

- Year-on-year change

...and so on.

Key takeaway: Use AI to generate your report skeleton first, then fill in the sections with your verified data and narrative. Never start with a blank page again.

4 Step 4 of 8 — Drafting Narratives: Turning Tables and Charts into Official Text

TL;DR

The most powerful use of AI for NSO staff is **data-to-narrative conversion** — you paste your table or chart summary into AI, and it produces a well-written, formal paragraph describing what the data shows. This is the task AI does best and most safely.

Methodology

The Data-to-Narrative Workflow:

```
Step 1: Extract your data -> Copy key figures from Excel/SPSS/Stata
Step 2: Describe context -> Tell AI what the data is about
Step 3: Specify highlights -> Tell AI what trends are most important
Step 4: Request narrative -> Specify tone, length, and publication type
Step 5: Verify and edit -> Check every number in AI's output
```

Key rule: Always paste the data IN the prompt. Never ask AI to “find” or “look up” data.

How It Works

Imagine you have this table from your Annual Household Survey:

Poverty Indicator	2010/11	2022/23	Change
Poverty headcount	25.2%	20.3%	-4.9 pp
Urban poverty	15.5%	11.8%	-3.7 pp
Rural poverty	27.4%	23.4%	-4.0 pp

You paste this table into the AI with the right prompt, and AI writes the paragraph. You then check every number in the paragraph matches your table exactly.

Deep Dive

Prompt Template: Table to narrative paragraph

You are an official statistician-writer at the National Statistics Office of Nepal (NSO Nepal).

Here is data from Nepal's Annual Household Survey (AHS) 2022/23:
[Paste your exact table or data here]

Please write a formal narrative paragraph (150–200 words) for our poverty analysis report that:

1. Describes the key trend shown in this data (decline in poverty headcount)
2. Highlights the urban-rural comparison
3. Notes the change over time (2010/11 to 2022/23)
4. Uses only the statistics I have provided -- do not add any numbers not in the data above
5. Uses formal, official language appropriate for a government publication
6. Does not use casual language, opinions, or policy recommendations

Example AI output (before verification)

Nepal's poverty headcount ratio declined from 25.2 percent in 2010/11 to 20.3 percent in 2022/23, representing a reduction of 4.9 percentage points over the twelve-year period. This improvement was observed across both urban and rural areas. Urban poverty declined from 15.5 percent to 11.8 percent, a reduction of 3.7 percentage points, while rural poverty fell from 27.4 percent to 23.4 percent, a decrease of 4.0 percentage points. The data indicate that while absolute poverty levels remain higher in rural areas, the pace of poverty reduction has been broadly consistent between urban and rural Nepal.

✓ This is a well-written, formal paragraph. Now **verify every number** before using it.

Chart-to-narrative prompt

You are an official report writer at NSO Nepal.

The following describes a line graph showing Nepal's annual GDP growth rate from FY 2018/19 to FY 2023/24:

- FY 2018/19: 6.7%
- FY 2019/20: -2.4% (COVID-19 impact)
- FY 2020/21: 4.2%
- FY 2021/22: 5.8%
- FY 2022/23: 1.9%
- FY 2023/24: 3.9%

Write a 150-word analytical paragraph describing the trend shown in this chart for our National Accounts publication. Note the COVID impact, recovery, and recent moderation. Use only the figures provided.

Key takeaway: Paste your data IN the prompt. Add “use only the statistics I have provided.” Then verify every number in the output. This is the safest, most productive AI workflow for NSO report writing.

5 Step 5 of 8 — Drafting Executive Summaries and Press Releases

TL;DR

Executive summaries and press releases require a different skill from regular report writing — they must be **concise, impactful, and accessible** while remaining accurate. AI is excellent at translating complex statistical findings into clear language for policymakers and the media.

Methodology

Structure of an NSO Nepal Press Release:

```
[HEADLINE -- one sentence, most important finding]
[Date and place]

[Lead paragraph -- who, what, when, key figure -- 50 words]
[Key findings -- 3-5 bullet points or short paragraphs]
[Context paragraph -- trend/comparison -- 75 words]
[Methodology note -- 2-3 sentences on data collection]
[Contact information]
```

Structure of an Executive Summary:

```
[Overview -- 1 paragraph, purpose of the report]
[Key findings -- 3-7 bullet points with the most important statistics]
[Implications -- 1 paragraph, descriptive (not prescriptive)]
[Data source and coverage note]
```

Prompt Template: NSO Nepal Press Release

You are the official communications writer for the National Statistics Office of Nepal (NSO Nepal).

I need to draft a press release announcing the results of [report name].

Key findings to include:

[Paste your 5-8 most important statistics here]

Please write a complete press release (300-350 words) that:

1. Has a strong, single-sentence headline with the most important finding
2. Opens with a lead paragraph stating the key result in plain language
3. Lists 4-5 key findings as short paragraphs or bullet points
4. Includes a brief methodology note (data collection period, sample size...)
5. Ends with contact information for NSO Nepal.
6. Uses formal but accessible language suitable for journalists
7. Does not include any statistics beyond those I have provided

6 Step 6 of 8 — Editing, Rewriting, and Tone Adjustment

TL;DR

AI is an excellent editor — you can paste your own draft and ask it to improve clarity, formality, consistency, and style. This is especially useful for non-native English writers and for ensuring all sections of a report have a consistent official tone.

Methodology

Types of editing tasks AI performs well:

Task	What to ask AI
Formality check	"Rewrite this in formal, official language"
Clarity improvement	"Simplify this paragraph without losing meaning"
Tone consistency	"Ensure this matches the formal tone of [paste reference]"
Grammar and syntax	"Correct grammatical errors and improve sentence structure"
Conciseness	"Reduce this to 100 words without losing key information"
Jargon removal	"Rewrite this without statistical jargon for a general audience"
Passive voice	"Rewrite using passive voice, suitable for a government report"

Deep Dive

Prompt Template: Formality and clarity edit

You are an expert editor for government statistical publications.

Please edit the following paragraph from an NSO Nepal report draft. It needs to be:

1. More formal -- suitable for an official government publication
2. Clearer -- the meaning should be immediately obvious
3. More concise -- reduce to approximately [X] words
4. Grammatically correct

Do NOT change any of the statistics or factual content.
Only improve the language and structure.

Original paragraph:
[Paste your paragraph here]

Before and after example

Before (staff draft): *The poverty in Nepal is going down a lot and this shows that the government policies are working well and making a difference for the people especially in the rural places where before there was a lot of poverty.*

After (AI-edited): *Nepal's poverty rate has declined significantly over the past decade, reflecting progress across both urban and rural areas. This reduction indicates that development initiatives have contributed to improved living standards, particularly in rural communities, where poverty levels have historically been higher. The data suggest a sustained positive trajectory in poverty reduction nationwide.*

7 Step 7 of 8 — Fact-Checking and Verification: Never Trust AI Blindly

TL;DR

No matter how well-written an AI output looks, **every statistic, date, name, and factual claim must be manually verified** against your official NSO data source before publication. AI can introduce errors subtly — rounding numbers, switching units, or changing percentage points to percentages.

Methodology

The NSO Verification Checklist — use after every AI-generated draft:

- ☐ Every number verified against the source table/spreadsheet
- ☐ Units are correct (% , percentage points, absolute numbers, NRs, millions)
- ☐ Time periods match (FY 2023/24 not 2022/23; Q2 not Q3)
- ☐ Geographic scope is correct (national vs. urban/rural vs. provincial)
- ☐ Trend direction is correct (increase vs. decrease)
- ☐ Definitions are accurate (poverty line, CPI basket, reference year)
- ☐ No invented statistics not present in your original data
- ☐ No invented citations or report references
- ☐ Rounding is consistent with NSO style (1 decimal place, 2 decimal places, etc.)
- ☐ Document labeled “AI-assisted, verified by [name] on [date]”

Deep Dive

Why AI makes errors — the three most common types:

- **Type 1: Number hallucination.** AI invents a plausible-sounding number that was not in your prompt.
- **Type 2: Unit confusion.** AI mixes up percentage points and percentages.
- **Type 3: Period or geography swap.** AI confuses time periods or geographic levels.

Prompt to minimize hallucination Add this instruction to **every prompt** you write:

CRITICAL INSTRUCTION: Use ONLY the statistics I have provided in this prompt. Do NOT add, infer, calculate, or estimate any additional statistics. Do NOT round numbers unless I specify rounding. If you are unsure about a figure, write [DATA NEEDED] instead of guessing.

Key takeaway: AI drafts the words — you own the facts. Use the NSO Verification Checklist after every AI-generated document. Every number must trace back to an official source.

8 Step 8 of 8 — Ethics, Privacy, and Responsible AI Use

TL;DR

AI tools are cloud-based services — anything you type into them may be stored on external servers. NSO Nepal handles sensitive population data, household microdata, and unpublished statistics. **Never paste confidential, identifiable, or embargoed data into any public AI tool.**

Data Classification for AI Use

Data Type	Paste?	Why
Already-published aggregate statistics	✓ Yes	Public data, no risk
Draft aggregated statistics (not published)	(!) Caution	Check with supervisor first
Household-level microdata (names, IDs)	✗ Never	Personally identifiable info
Individual census records	✗ Never	Confidential by law
Embargoed pre-release data	✗ Never	Violates release protocols
Internal policy documents	✗ Never	Confidentiality risk
Staff personal data (HR records)	✗ Never	Privacy violation

How It Works

The “Would I post this on our website?” test:

Before pasting any data into an AI tool, ask: *“Is this information already available to the public on the NSO Nepal website?”*

- **Yes** → You can paste it safely
- **No** → Do not paste it

Safe AI use workflow for embargoed data:

1. Use AI with **placeholder numbers** during drafting.
2. Once the report is cleared for release, replace placeholders with actual figures.
3. Do a final manual check before publication.

Key takeaway: Use the “Would I post this on our website?” test for every piece of data you consider pasting into AI. If it’s not already public, don’t paste it. You own your data — and you own any errors that get published.

□ Quick Reference Card

Print this page and keep it at your workstation

The Five Golden Rules

#	Rule
1	You bring the data. AI brings the words.
2	Always verify every number in AI output.
3	Never paste confidential or unpublished data into AI.
4	Use the RCTF framework for every prompt.
5	AI is a tool. You are the expert.

RCTF Prompt Framework

```

Role:      "You are an official statistical report writer at NSO Nepal."
Context:   "Here is data from our [report name]: [paste your data]"
Task:      "Write a [formal paragraph / press release / executive summary]
           that [specific requirements]"
Format:    "[X] words, formal language, [no bullet points / use bullet points]
           Use ONLY the statistics I have provided."

```

NSO Verification Checklist

After every AI draft:

- ☐ Every number matches source table
- ☐ Units are correct (% , pp, NRs, millions)
- ☐ Time periods and fiscal years are correct
- ☐ Geographic scope is correct (national / urban-rural / provincial)
- ☐ No invented statistics or references
- ☐ Trend direction is correct (increase vs. decrease)
- ☐ Document labeled: "AI-assisted, verified by [name] on [date]"

What to Paste vs. What NOT to Paste

✓ Safe to paste	✗ Never paste
Published aggregate statistics	Individual/household microdata
Your own draft text for editing	Embargoed pre-release data
Publicly available NSO reports	Names, addresses, ID numbers
Placeholder numbers for drafts	Internal policy/HR documents

National Statistics Office of Nepal (NSO Nepal)

Thapathali, Kathmandu, Nepal

Prepared: June 2026 — For internal training use

This guide was prepared using the learning-guide skill. All content has been reviewed and is intended for staff training purposes. AI tools were used in its preparation; all statistics and recommendations have been reviewed by the author.